SETUP · STEP BY STEP

Set up a voice pack // HCS & VoiceAttack

Set up the HCS Hub, VoiceAttack and a voice pack on Windows 11 and Star Citizen. For all HCS packs and with no prior Windows knowledge, using Ripley as the example.

00 What this is about

Understand first, then click

With an **HCS voice pack** you talk to your ship: you say `Deploy landing gear`, the gear comes down and a voice answers. Three programs work together for this:

- **VoiceAttack** is the engine: it listens to your microphone and presses the matching key in the game.
- **The voice pack** is the voice, for example Ripley. This guide uses Ripley as its example, but the steps apply to every HCS Star Citizen pack.
- **The HCS Hub** is the manager: this is where you install and update everything.

You need:

- A Windows PC with Star Citizen
- A working microphone, ideally a headset
- An HCS voice pack and a registered copy of VoiceAttack. The trial is not enough. HCS “starter bundles” include both.
- Some English: according to HCS you speak the commands in English.

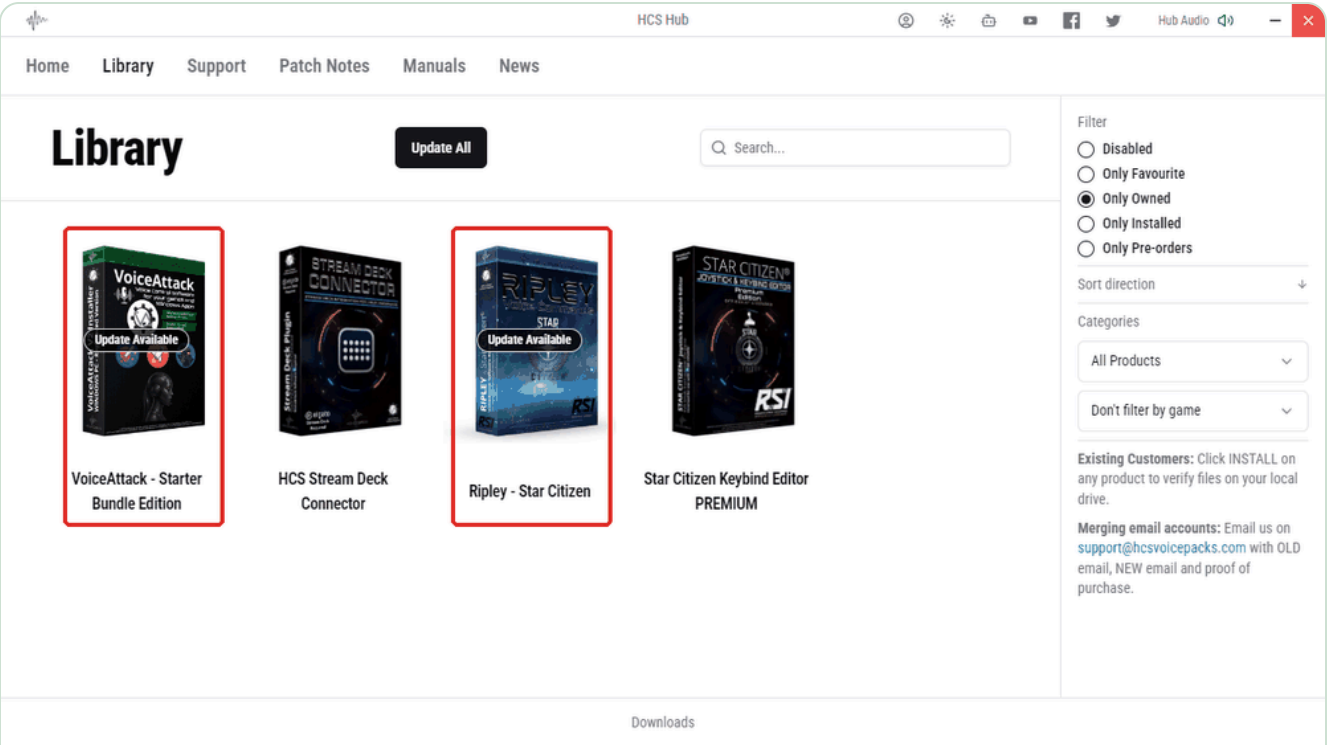
SCOPE OF THIS GUIDE

The images come from a real installation (Windows 11, HCS Hub 1.0.2, VoiceAttack 2.1.8, HCS plugin 4.1.9.0), personal details are covered in grey. Step 05 (English speech recognition) and the in-game steps were not run through here: they follow the VoiceAttack and HCS instructions. Menu names can change with updates.

01 Set up the HCS Hub

The manager for everything

1. Buy your pack in the HCS store. Remember the email address you use.
2. Download the **HCS Hub** from the link in your purchase confirmation or from the HCS install page and install it.
3. Start the Hub and sign in with the same email address. You do not need a licence key.
4. Open the **Library** tab at the top. Everything you bought appears there.

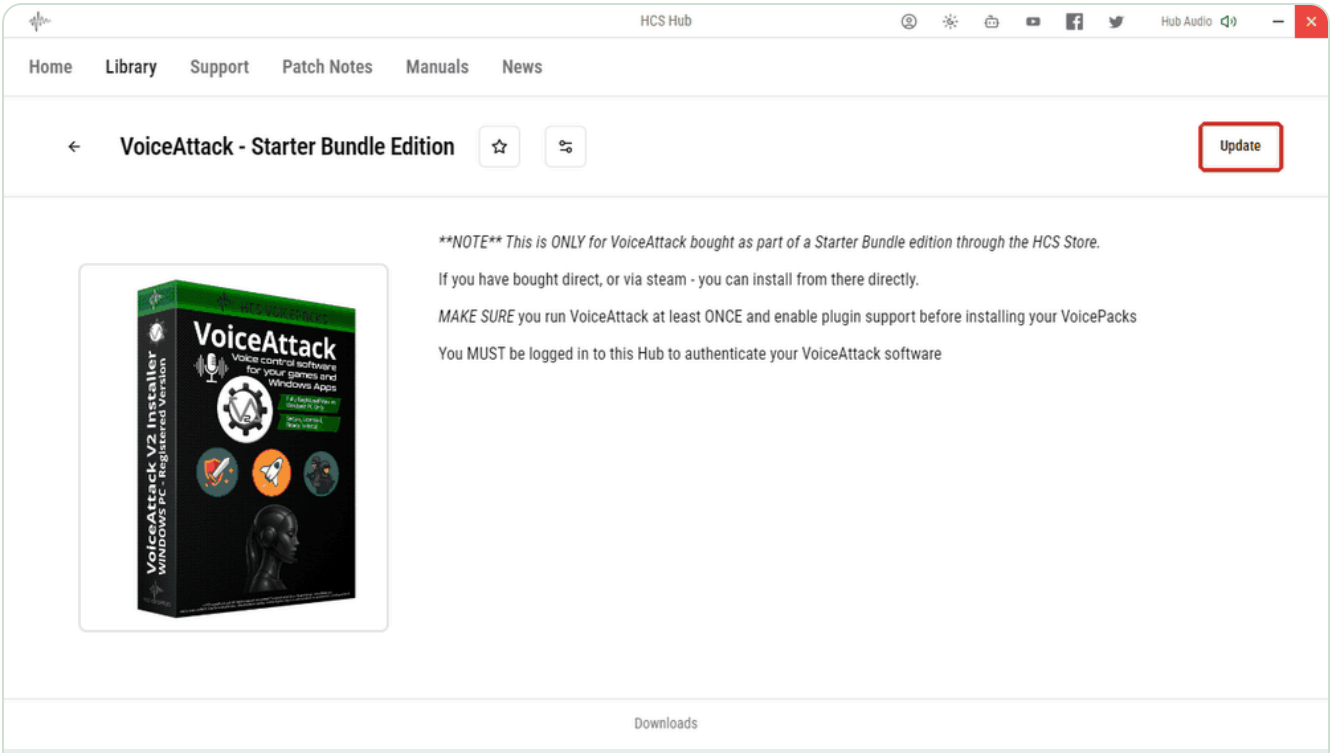


The Library shows your purchases. Marked: VoiceAttack and the pack, Ripley here. You may see other packs.

02 Install VoiceAttack

The engine comes first

1. In the Library click **VoiceAttack**, then **Install** at the top right. If it says **Update**, it is already installed and a newer version exists.
2. Wait until the installation has finished.



The button at the top right installs or updates the program. On your first run it says “Install”.

BOUGHT ELSEWHERE? The Hub entry only covers the “Starter Bundle Edition”. If you bought VoiceAttack directly or on Steam, install it from there.

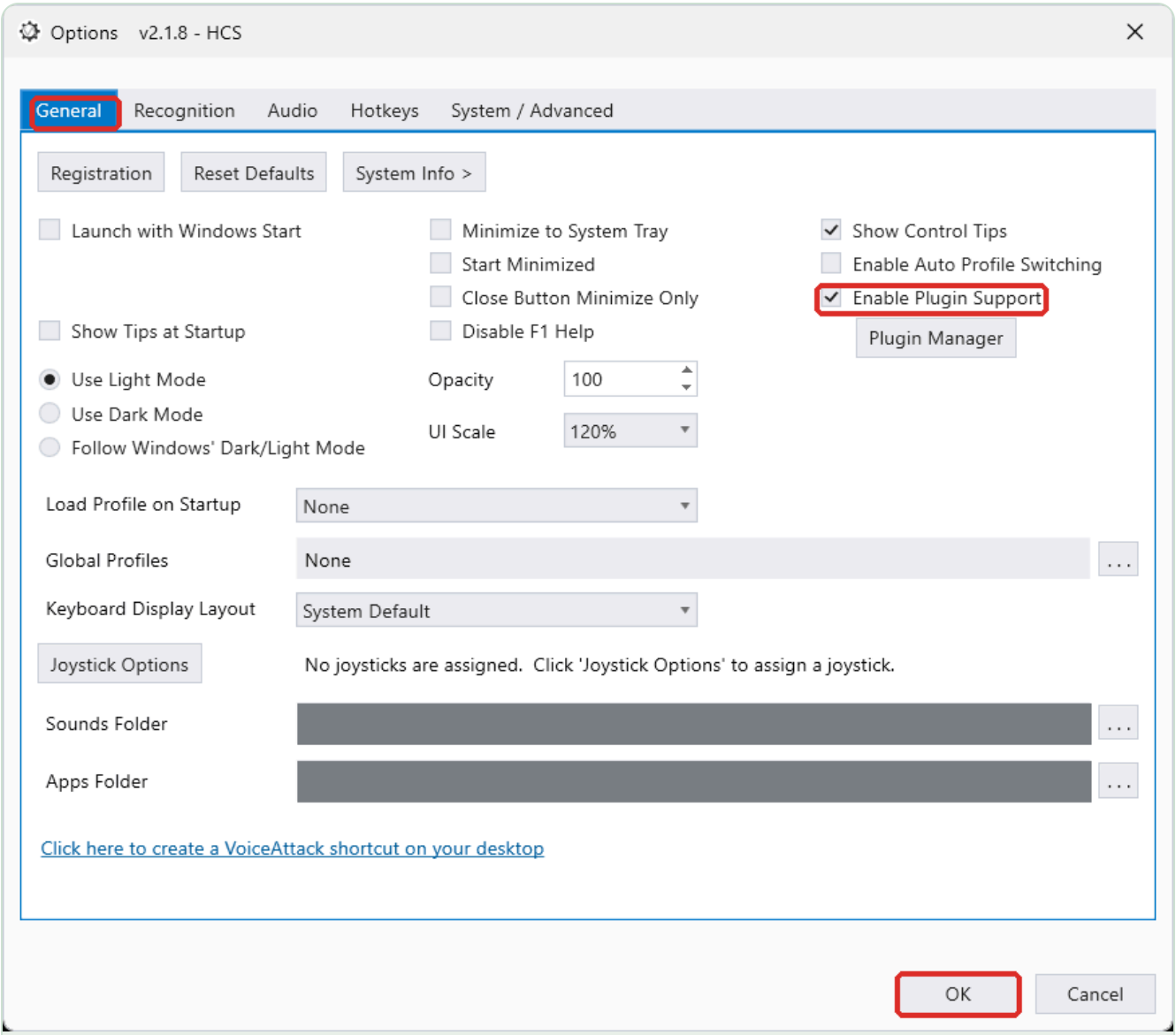
03

Start VoiceAttack once

Important before the pack arrives

HCS explicitly requires this step before installing a pack: VoiceAttack must have run once and plugin support must be on. A plugin is an add-on that lets the pack work with VoiceAttack.

1. Start **VoiceAttack** from the Start menu or desktop shortcut. You must be signed in to the Hub.
2. Click the **wrench** at the bottom right of the window. The options open.
3. On the **General** tab, tick **Enable Plugin Support**.
4. Click **OK** and close VoiceAttack.



Options, General tab: tick “Enable Plugin Support”, then OK.

04 Install the voice pack

Now the voice arrives

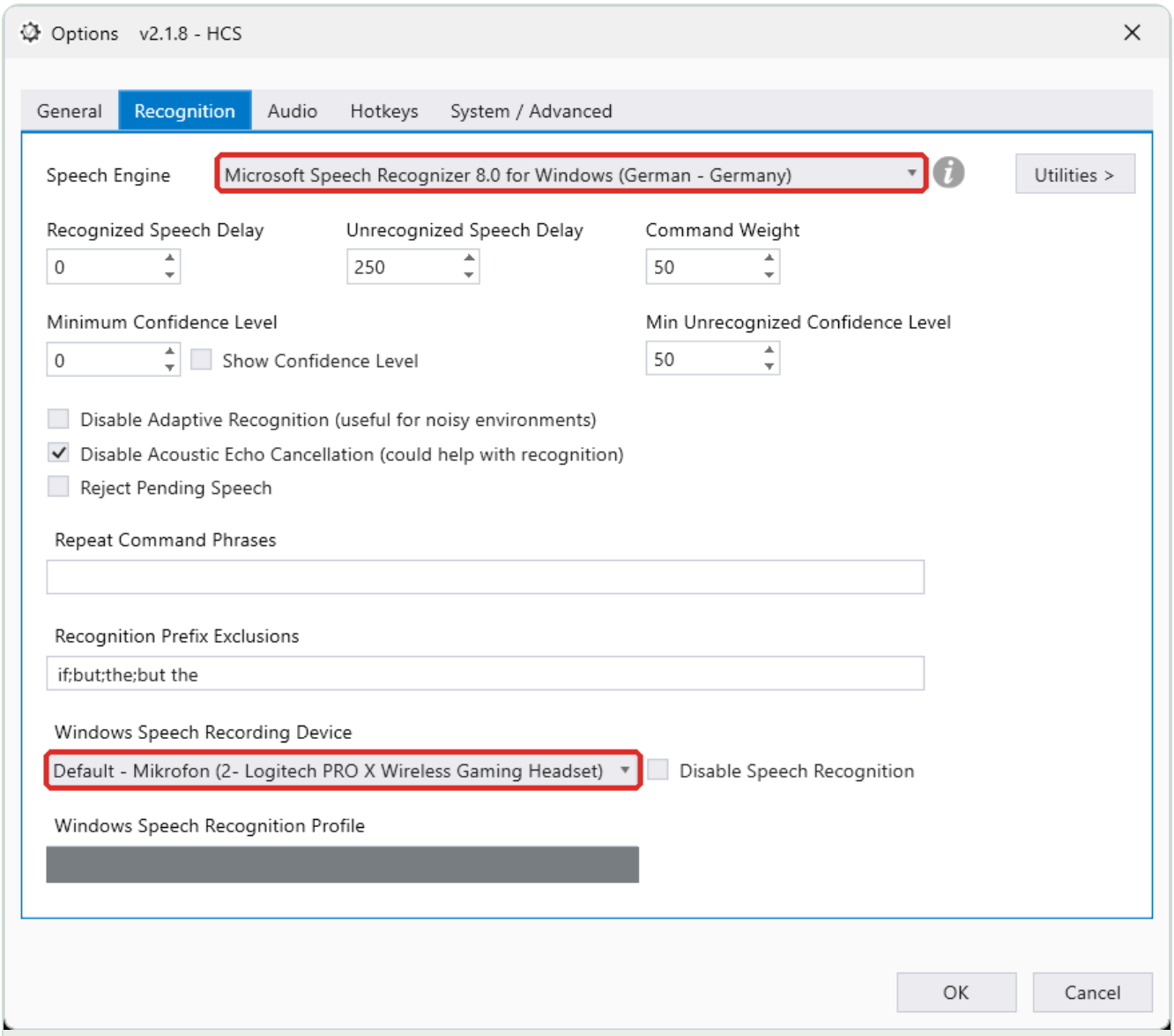
1. VoiceAttack must be closed.
2. In the Library click your pack, for example **Ripley - Star Citizen**.
3. Click **Install** at the top right and wait until it has finished.
4. If you have several packs, repeat this for each one. They all run in the same profile later.

UPDATING LATER If “Update Available” appears on a pack, close VoiceAttack and use **Update** or **Update All** in the Hub. If you changed anything in the customiser, first save your settings there with **Backup Settings**.

05 Microphone and speech recognition

The most common stumbling block

VoiceAttack uses Windows speech recognition. Open the wrench again and go to the **Recognition** tab. Two fields matter:



Recognition tab. Top: the speech engine. Bottom: the microphone. The German engine is still selected here.

- **Windows Speech Recording Device:** your microphone must be listed here. If not, pick it from the list.
- **Speech Engine:** the commands are in English. If only "German - Germany" (or another non-English language) is listed, recognition may be poor: according to reports in the VoiceAttack forum, a non-English engine handles English commands badly. Feel free to try it first (see step 08), and install English if commands are often missed.

INSTALLING ENGLISH RECOGNITION

These steps come from the VoiceAttack instructions. They temporarily change your Windows display language.

1. Open Windows **Settings** (Windows key + I), then **Time & language** and **Language & region**.
2. Click **Add a language**, find **English (United States)** and click **Next**.
3. Tick the language pack, text-to-speech and basic speech recognition. Also tick the option that makes English your display language. You do not need enhanced speech recognition or handwriting. Click **Install**.
4. Restart VoiceAttack and on the **Recognition** tab choose the English engine under **Speech Engine**.
5. Do the speech training (next section). Afterwards you can switch your Windows display language back. For later training you need to switch it again.



Windows Settings, Language & region: the installation starts here (German Windows shown).

SPEECH TRAINING

The built-in Windows engines have to learn your voice. VoiceAttack calls this an important step and recommends repeating it after changing microphones. The VoiceAttack instructions advise **at least three runs**. Start it in the HCS customiser (step 07) with **Speech Training**, or in the VoiceAttack options under **Utilities**.

INSTALLATION FAILS? For damaged Windows speech components, the VoiceAttack instructions name reinstalling Windows as the last resort. There is a simpler alternative before that: the Speech Platform engines. They need no training but are less accurate. Do ask in the HCS Discord before taking such a big step.

06 Choose the profile

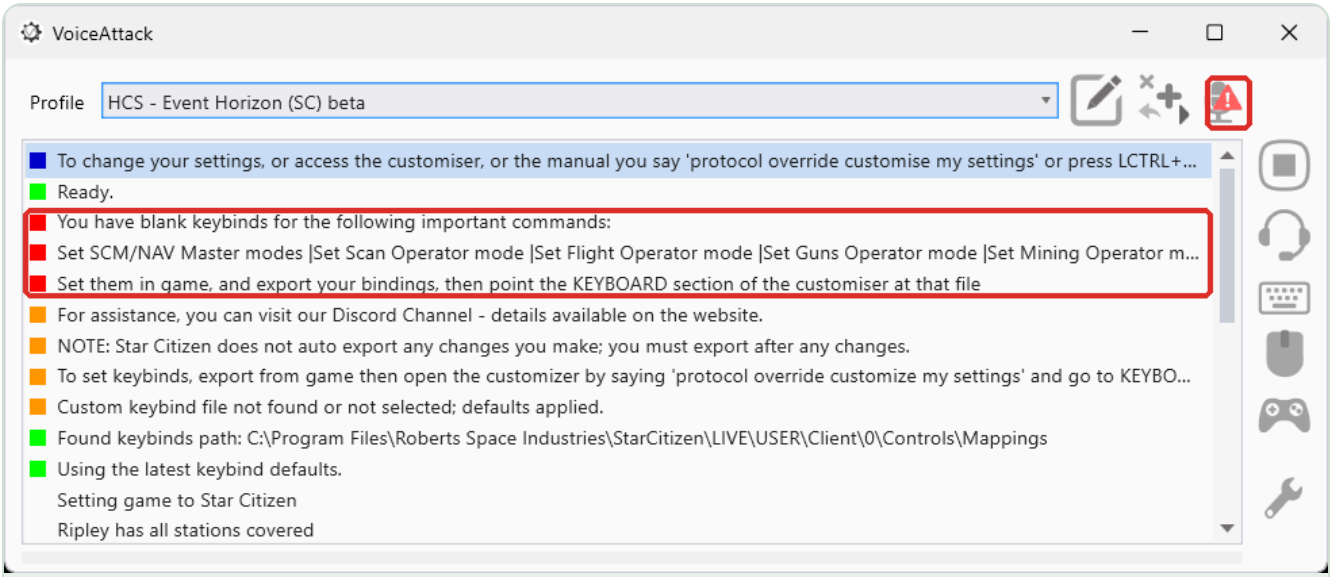
So VoiceAttack knows the commands

1. Start VoiceAttack.
2. In the **Profile** list at the top choose **HCS – Event Horizon (SC) beta**. Event Horizon is the shared profile of all Star Citizen packs. It detects your pack by itself.



Profile list open. “My Profile” contains no pack commands.

The window then fills with messages. Green and blue are fine, orange are hints, red needs your attention:



Top right: the microphone warning. Middle: the red lines listing keys that are still blank (step 07).

- **Red triangle on the microphone:** hover over it. If VoiceAttack reports "No Signal / Low Signal", check that the headset is on, not muted and loud enough.
- **"privileges not elevated":** this is only a hint. You only need administrator rights if key presses do not reach the game (see Troubleshooting).

07 Set up the keys

The pack presses keyboard keys

The pack triggers commands through **keyboard and mouse keys**. Joystick or controller buttons do not count. It assumes the game's default keys. Some important commands have **no key** by default, though, and without a key the voice command does not work:

- The "set" commands for the operator modes: scan, quantum, missiles, guns, salvage, mining
- The "set" commands for NAV and SCM modes
- Other blank commands, such as the helmet. The red lines in VoiceAttack tell you which ones are missing.

IN THE GAME

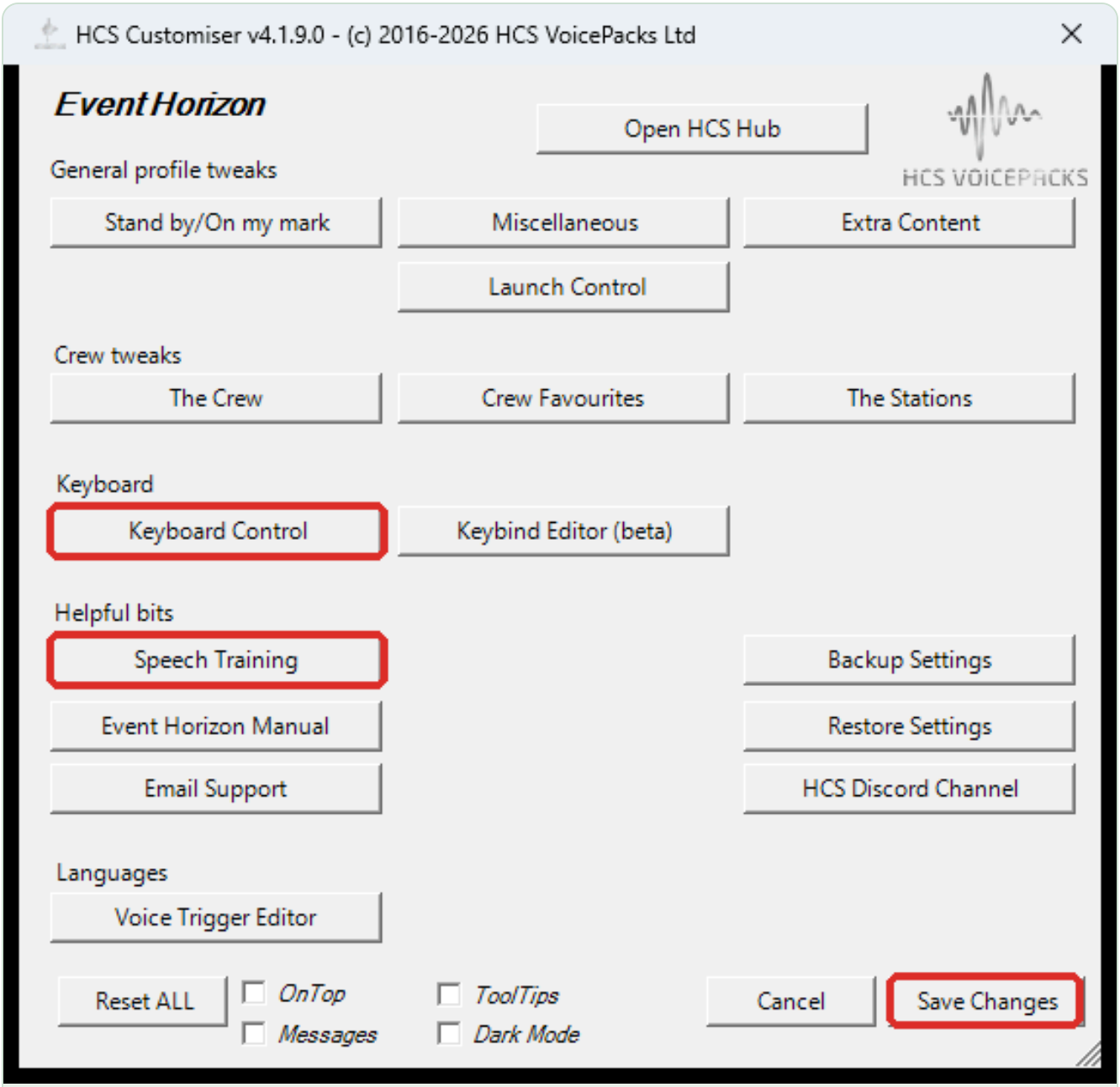
1. Start Star Citizen and open **Options**, then **Keybindings** and **Advanced Controls Customization**.

2. Assign a free key to each missing command. Do not use a modifier such as Ctrl or Alt on its own.
3. Click **Control Profiles** at the bottom, then **Save Control Settings**, and enter a simple name such as `voicepack`.

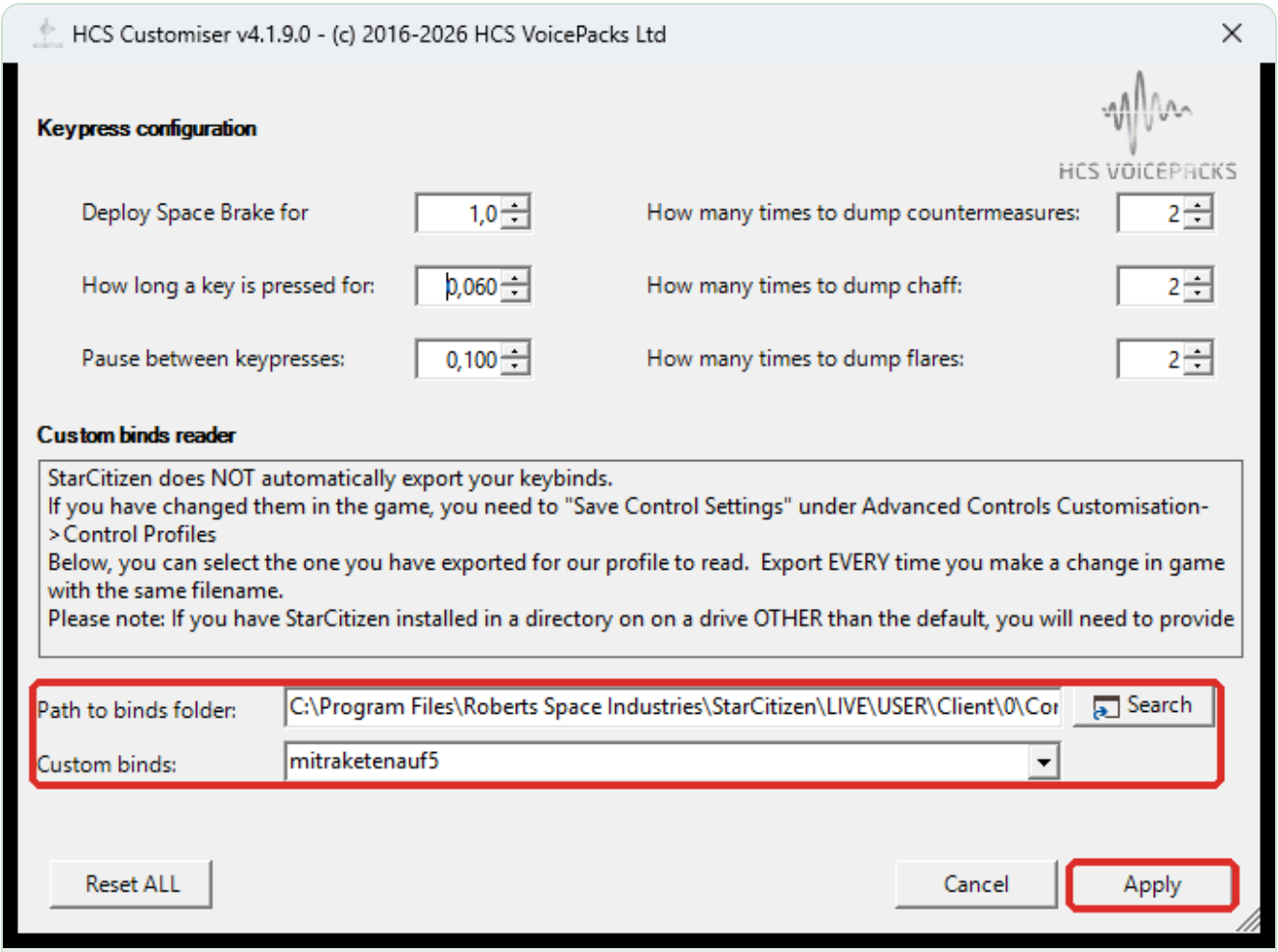
> SAVE AGAIN EVERY TIME
> Star Citizen does not write your keys to this file by itself. After **every** change in the game you must save again under the same name.

IN THE HCS CUSTOMISER

1. Open the customiser: with VoiceAttack running, press `Ctrl` + `Alt` + `Shift` + `Enter`. Or say `Protocol override, customise my settings`.
2. Click **Keyboard Control**.
3. Under **Custom binds** choose the name you saved. If it is not listed, click **Search**. The game stores the file in the folder `StarCitizen\LIVE\USER\Client\0\Controls\Mappings`.
4. Click **Apply**, then **Save Changes** in the main window, and restart VoiceAttack.



Customiser: Keyboard Control for the keys, Speech Training for your voice, Save Changes to save. VoiceAttack ignores commands while it is open.



Keyboard Control: choose the folder and saved bindings, then Apply. Your own name appears instead of the example.

If the red lines are gone after the restart, it worked.

08 First flight

Order and test commands

1. Start **VoiceAttack first** and check that the Event Horizon profile is selected.
2. Then start Star Citizen and get into your ship.
3. Speak clearly at a normal pace: `Deploy landing gear`, then `Retract landing gear`.
4. If it fails, look at the VoiceAttack window: it shows what was understood. A red message points to a command without a key.

GOT SEVERAL PACKS? Say `Crew command roster`, then `Crewman Ripley` (or your character's name), `Take all stations` and finally `That is all`. With only one pack, it covers all stations by itself.

All commands are in the manual: in the customiser under **Event Horizon Manual**, or in the Hub under **Manuals**.

09 Troubleshooting

The most common cases

PROBLEM	WHAT HELPS
VoiceAttack does not react at all	Check the triangle on the microphone and the device on the **Recognition** tab. Is the listening button off? It toggles listening (`Ctrl` + `L` in the VoiceAttack window). Is the customiser still open?
Commands are often misunderstood	Check for the English engine (step 05), repeat the speech training, reduce background noise. Noise filters in the headset or software can worsen the signal.
VoiceAttack understands, nothing happens in game	Does the command have a key (step 07)? Is Star Citizen in the foreground? If that does not help, enable **Run VoiceAttack as an Administrator** under **System / Advanced** in the options.
“Switch to … mode” does not work	The “set” key for it is blank. Assign it in the game, save and choose it in the customiser (step 07).
My key change has no effect	Save again under the same name in the game and restart VoiceAttack.
A command runs only partly, or menus do not open properly	Raise the timings a little under **Keyboard Control** in the customiser. Star Citizen is an alpha: the game itself can also be the cause.
The profile is missing from the list	Check plugin support (step 03), then reinstall or update the pack in the Hub.

More help: under **Support** in the Hub you will find the HCS Discord and YouTube tutorials. For purchases and accounts, write to support@hcsvoicepacks.com.

SOURCES

- HCS: What is a voice pack? · Installation · manuals in the Hub (Event Horizon, Keybind Tools)
- VoiceAttack: help v2 (in the program) · Installing SAPI engines · Alternate engines

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